

ASEN 3502 Computational Methods

Lab 2: Nonlinear Equations

Exact Due Date on Gradescope

General Instructions

1. You may use any programming language, and you may use different languages for different parts. However, the primary goal of this lab is understanding, and *you should use Matlab unless every team member is enthusiastic about using something else.*
2. Adhere to the AI policy at asen3502.com/ai-policy.

In a gas, pressure information travels at the speed of sound. When an aircraft flies faster than the speed of sound, information cannot flow upstream to smoothly divert the flow. This means that the airflow must change direction near instantaneously to move around the aircraft. This abrupt deflection and compression is known as a shock. In this lab, we will solve nonlinear equations that determine the angle of oblique shocks.

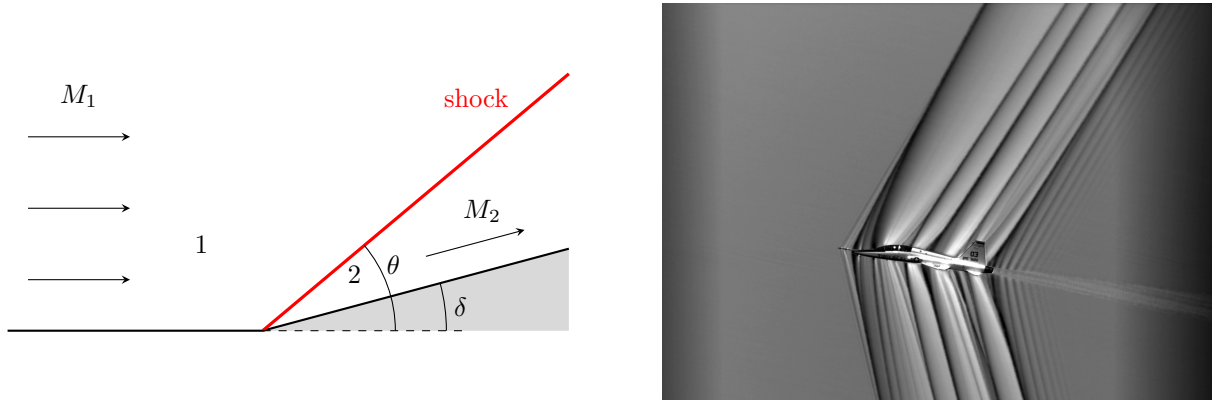


Figure 1: Left: Oblique shock on a wedge of angle δ . Right: schlieren image of a T-38 in supersonic flight (NASA).

Supersonic flow at Mach number M_1 over a wedge of angle δ (Figure 1) produces an oblique shock at angle θ given by NACA Report 1135, Eq. 139b:

$$\tan \delta = \frac{M_1^2 \sin 2\theta - 2 \cot \theta}{2 + M_1^2 (\gamma + \cos 2\theta)}. \quad (1)$$

This equation does not have a simple analytic solution for θ , so we will solve it using numerical methods. For sufficiently small δ , the equation has two solutions, the smaller “weak” solution usually encountered in the real world, and the higher “strong” solution. If δ is too large, an oblique shock is impossible and a normal shock forms in front of the wedge, invalidating Equation (1). Throughout this lab, the ratio of specific heats, $\gamma = c_p/c_v$, is 1.4, and the Mach angle, μ , is $\sin^{-1}(\frac{1}{M})$. Notation follows NACA Report 1135.

Deliverables (at end of Week 2)

1. To the **Lab 2 Writeup** assignment on Gradescope: A **single pdf** writeup that contains all of the items marked [writeup](#).
 - Make sure to clearly label all plots and figures and use correct units where appropriate.
 - The lab writeup does *not* need to include narrative text unless specifically requested; it can just include the plot or results from each [writeup](#) task labeled with which task they are from.
2. To the **Lab 2 Code** assignment on Gradescope: Your **source code** for all [code](#) items.
 - Please help the TAs by clearly naming your files.
 - In this lab, you will *not* be graded based on documentation or comments in your code. (Though in practice, documentation is extremely important!)

1 Week 1: Oblique Shock Angle

1.1 Define the model

[writeup](#)[code](#)

Define a residual function $f(\delta, \theta, M)$ that will be zero at the solutions of Equation (1). Implement this as a function `shock_residual(delta, theta, M)`. Since the solvers you write later will accept a function of the unknown θ only, you can fix δ and M and create $f(\theta)$ with an anonymous function in Matlab:

```
delta = deg2rad(20) % if shock_residual expects degrees (you can do it either way)
M = 3
f = @(theta) shock_residual(delta, theta, M)
```

Plot $f(\theta)$ for $M_1 = 3$ and $\delta = 10^\circ, 20^\circ, 30^\circ, 40^\circ$ on the interval $\mu \leq \theta \leq 90^\circ$. As in all plots, make sure to label all axes and provide a legend when appropriate. Identify the weak root, the strong root, and the case with no root and note these in the writeup.

1.2 Derive and verify the derivative

[writeup](#)[code](#)

Derive $f'(\theta) = \frac{\partial}{\partial \theta} f(\delta, \theta, M)$ analytically (Hint: define N and D so that $f(\delta, \theta, M) = N/D - \tan \delta$ and use the quotient rule) and implement it in `shock_derivative(delta, theta, M)`. Write a script `verify_derivative` that compares to a finite difference approximation

$$f'(\theta) \approx \frac{f(\theta + h) - f(\theta)}{h}$$

at several values of θ and δ . Choose h so that it is very small, but not small enough to cause roundoff errors.

1.3 Implement root-finding algorithms

[code](#)

Implement a subset of the following root-finding methods:

- (a) incremental search
- (b) bisection
- (c) Newton-Raphson
- (d) secant
- (e) Brent's method (advanced)

Your team must implement **at least four of the methods**, and **each team member must implement at least one**. All of the methods should use the interface

```
[x, info] = method_name(f, fprime, interval, atol, maxit)
```

where **f** and **fprime** are handles for functions that accept one argument, **interval** is a two-element vector, and **x** is a root estimate within absolute tolerance (E_s) **atol** of a true root. **info** is a struct for auxiliary output; use **info = struct()**; for now. Some methods will ignore or reinterpret some arguments.

1.4 Verification script

[code](#)

Write a script **verify_root_find** that tests every method on a function with a known root. It should use a subfunction **test_root_find** that takes a solver function handle and causes an error via **assert** if the solve fails. Call **test_root_find** with each of the solve functions. Starter code for this task is given in **verify_root_find.m**.

1.5 Solve for the shock angle

[writeup](#)[code](#)

For $M_1 = 3$, $\delta = 20^\circ$, find the weak and strong shock angles to within 10^{-6} degrees with every method. Mark your solutions on the θ vs δ Chart 2 in NACA 1135 (Recommendation: use screenshots of the pdf).

1.6 Convergence study

[writeup](#)[code](#)

Add two fields to the **info** struct returned by each solver: **info.history.funcCount**, a vector with the cumulative number of **f** and **fprime** calls after each iteration, and **info.history.x**, a vector with the best root estimate after each iteration. For the weak shock in Task 1.5, plot the error in the estimate versus **funcCount** for all methods on a log scale. If one method needs drastically more calls than the others, plot it on its own figure.

1.7 Initial guess dependence

[writeup](#)

For Newton-Raphson, sweep the initial guess across $\mu \leq \theta_0 \leq 90^\circ$ and record whether each guess converges to the weak root, the strong root, or fails. Present the result as a plot or table.

2 Week 2: Intersecting Shocks

Managing shocks in intakes in supersonic flight is a key challenge for high performance aircraft. The F-15 used a complex variable-geometry intake to achieve its Mach 2.5 top speed. Figure 2 shows a supersonic intake. Shocks A and B from the ramp (δ_A) and cowl lip (δ_B) intersect and continue as refracted shocks C and D. Regions 4 and 4' are separated by a slip line at angle ϕ across which pressure and flow direction are equal but Mach number is not.

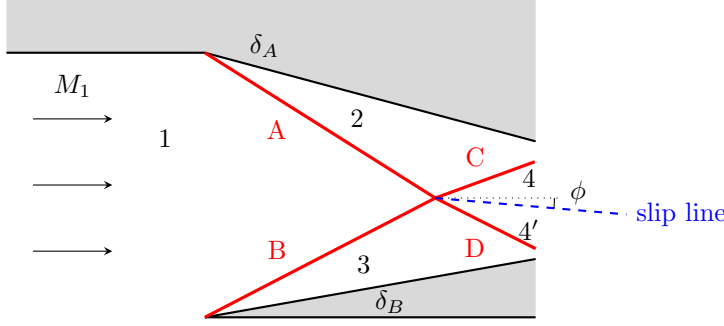


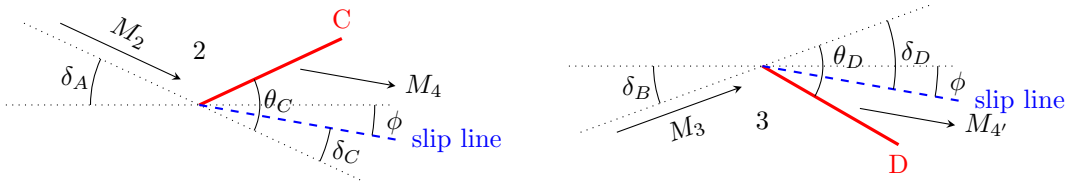
Figure 2: Intersection of shocks of opposite families (after Anderson Fig. 9.21). Right: the rectangular ramp inlets of an F-15 (USAF).

For a generic shock from upstream state u to downstream state d , NACA 1135 Eqs. 128, 131 give

$$\frac{p_d}{p_u} = \frac{2\gamma M_u^2 \sin^2 \theta - (\gamma - 1)}{\gamma + 1}, \quad (2)$$

$$M_d^2 \sin^2(\theta - \delta) = \frac{(\gamma - 1)M_u^2 \sin^2 \theta + 2}{2\gamma M_u^2 \sin^2 \theta - (\gamma - 1)}. \quad (3)$$

The incident shocks are solved with Week 1 tools: θ_A from (M_1, δ_A) and θ_B from (M_1, δ_B) , then p_2/p_1 , M_2 , p_3/p_1 , M_3 from Eqs. (2) and (3). With ϕ taken positive when the slip line tilts toward the cowl, as drawn, the refracted shocks deflect the flow by $\delta_C = \delta_A - \phi$ and $\delta_D = \delta_B + \phi$ as shown below:



The three unknowns ϕ , θ_C , θ_D satisfy the two shock-angle relations

$$\tan \delta_C = \frac{M_2^2 \sin 2\theta_C - 2 \cot \theta_C}{2 + M_2^2(\gamma + \cos 2\theta_C)}, \quad \tan \delta_D = \frac{M_3^2 \sin 2\theta_D - 2 \cot \theta_D}{2 + M_3^2(\gamma + \cos 2\theta_D)}, \quad (4)$$

and pressure continuity across the slip line,

$$\frac{p_2}{p_1} \frac{p_4}{p_2} = \frac{p_3}{p_1} \frac{p_{4'}}{p_3}, \quad (5)$$

where p_4/p_2 is Eq. (2) evaluated with (M_2, θ_C) and $p_{4'}/p_3$ with (M_3, θ_D) .

We will solve for the specific case where

$$M_1 = 3, \quad \delta_A = 15^\circ, \quad \delta_B = 10^\circ.$$

2.1 Define the model

[writeup](#)[code](#)

Define a new residual function $f(\phi, \theta_C, \theta_D, M_2, M_3, \delta_A, \delta_B, p_2/p_1, p_3/p_1)$, implemented in matlab as

```
shock_refraction_residual(phi, thetaC, thetaD, M2, M3, deltaA, deltaB, p2p1, p3p1)
```

that returns a three-element vector that is zero when Equations 4 and 5 are satisfied. In later steps, you will create an anonymous function that accepts a vector of unknowns

```
f = @(x) shock_refraction_residual(x(1), x(2), x(3), M2, M3, deltaA, deltaB, p2p1, p3p1)
```

that represents $\{f\}(\{x\})$ where

$$\{x\} = \begin{Bmatrix} \phi \\ \theta_C \\ \theta_D \end{Bmatrix}.$$

2.2 Numerical Jacobian and Verification

[code](#)

Write a function $J = \text{numjac}(f, x, h)$ that approximates the Jacobian by forward differences, one column per perturbed component of x . Write a verification script that tests it on the system

$$\{f\}(\{x\}) = \begin{Bmatrix} x_1^2 x_2 - 1 \\ x_1 + x_2^3 - 2 \end{Bmatrix},$$

at several values of $\{x\}$.

2.3 Multivariate Newton-Raphson

[code](#)

Write $[x, \text{info}] = \text{newton_sys}(f, J, x_0, \text{atol}, \text{maxit})$ where J is a function handle, e.g. $\text{@}(x) \text{ numjac}(f, x, h)$. Use one of your programs from Lab 1 for the linear solve step.

2.4 Verification

[code](#)

Write `verify_newton_sys` that solves a small system with a known solution (e.g. the intersection of a circle and a line) and checks the result.

2.5 Solve for initial shock angles

[writeup](#)[code](#)

Use your code from week 1 and Equations 2 and 3 to find θ_A , θ_B , M_2 , M_3 , $\frac{p_2}{p_1}$ and $\frac{p_3}{p_1}$. Report the values that you found in the writeup.

2.6 Shock intersection

[writeup](#)[code](#)

Solve Eqs. (4)–(5) with `newton_sys`. Report ϕ , θ_C , θ_D , and p_4/p_1 .

2.7 Initial guess sensitivity

[writeup](#)[code](#)

Repeat Task 2.6 from at least 3 initial guesses and report where Newton-Raphson converges, or that it does not converge, in each case. Choose initial guesses that converge to at least two distinct solutions.